

Nazism

Nazism also had its roots in the First World War and the nationalist politics of a charismatic leader, Adolf Hitler. Nazism developed quite separately from Italian fascism, evolving from the German Workers' Party, which later became the Nationalsozialistische Deutsche Arbeiterpartei (NSDAP), from which the word 'Nazi' is derived. Hitler shifted the NSDAP towards ultranationalism and a rejection of both communism and capitalism, which he denounced as Jewish conspiracies.

A year after a failed coup, he led the party to legitimate power in 1933, gaining support for the Nazi ideology of expansionist nationalism based on the idea of an Aryan 'master race'. Officially a revolutionary socialist movement, Nazism under Hitler became increasingly overtly right-wing and authoritarian, and the nationalism more racist. Today Nazism is synonymous with extreme right-wing authoritarianism, coupled with extreme ethnic nationalism, characterized by notions of racial supremacy and antisemitism.

